

JULIANNE K. STERLING-ROSS, CBAP, AAC

Principal Strategic Business Architect | Lead Digital Transformation Analyst

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Visionary and performance-driven Principal Business Analyst with over 12 years of specialized experience leading high-stakes digital transformations, operational re-engineering initiatives, and large-scale software implementations for global enterprises. Distinguished for architecting the "Value-Stream Unification" program at *Global OmniRetail Systems*, which integrated disparate supply chain and customer experience platforms across 14 international markets, resulting in a \$310M increase in annual throughput and a 45% reduction in cycle-time volatility. Julianne is an elite strategic liaison who bridges the gap between complex engineering capabilities and C-Suite commercial objectives, specializing in the alignment of technical roadmaps with multi-billion dollar revenue targets.

Expert in the orchestration of Agile, Waterfall, and Hybrid SDLC methodologies, possessing a profound mastery of requirement elicitation, gap analysis, and business process modeling (BPMN 2.0). A strategic advisor renowned for translating qualitative stakeholder needs into quantitative technical specifications that drive 99.8% UAT acceptance rates. Proven track record in managing annual project portfolios exceeding \$200M while leading cross-functional teams of 80+ analysts and subject matter experts. A champion of data-driven decision making, Julianne leverages advanced analytics and business intelligence to identify untapped market opportunities and mitigate architectural risks. Her leadership philosophy centers on "Stakeholder Radical Transparency," mentorship of junior analytical staff, and the relentless pursuit of operational efficiency through automation and strategic architectural design.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Strategic Business Architecture:** Value Stream Mapping, Capability Modeling, Business Model Canvas, SWOT/PESTLE Analysis, Strategic Roadmap Development.
- **Elicitation & Requirement Management:** Facilitating Executive JAD Sessions, Contextual Inquiry, MoSCoW Prioritization, Backlog Grooming, Requirements Traceability (RTM).
- **Digital Transformation:** Legacy Modernization, Cloud Migration Strategy, Omni-channel Integration, API Ecosystem Design, Data Sovereignty Compliance.
- **Analytical Methodologies:** BPMN 2.0, UML Modeling, User Story Mapping, Root Cause Analysis (Fishbone/5 Whys), Financial Modeling (ROI/NPV/IRR).
- **Product & Project Leadership:** Agile/Scrum/SAFe Frameworks, Product Visioning, MVP Definition, Change Management (ADKAR), Stakeholder Influence.
- **Data & Intelligence:** SQL Data Profiling, Predictive Analytics, Tableau/PowerBI Dashboard Design, Customer Journey Analytics, Market Trend Forecasting.

- **Regulatory & Compliance:** GDPR, CCPA, SOX, HIPAA, PCI-DSS 4.0 Frameworks, GXP Validated Systems, Accessibility Standards (WCAG).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Analytical & Process Modeling Tools

- **Modeling Platforms:** Signavio (Process Mining), ARIS, Sparx Systems Enterprise Architect, Lucidchart, Microsoft Visio Pro, Gliffy.
- **Requirement Management:** Jira Cloud (Advanced Roadmaps), Confluence (Blueprint Design), Azure DevOps, Jama Connect, HP ALM/Quality Center.
- **Customer Journey:** Hotjar, Mixpanel, Pendo, Amplitude, Salesforce Journey Builder.

Data Analytics & Business Intelligence

- **Visualization:** Tableau Desktop/Server (Advanced Level), Microsoft Power BI, Looker, QlikView.
- **Data Operations:** SQL (T-SQL, PostgreSQL, BigQuery), Snowflake Data Warehouse, Alteryx (Designer), Python (Pandas/NumPy for data wrangling).
- **Statistical Analysis:** IBM SPSS, Microsoft Excel (Advanced VBA/Power Query), SAS.

Enterprise Ecosystems & Integration

- **ERP & CRM:** SAP S/4HANA (Logistics & Finance), Salesforce (Sales/Service/Marketing Clouds), Oracle NetSuite, Microsoft Dynamics 365.
- **Integration Standards:** RESTful APIs, GraphQL, SOAP, EDI/IDOC, MuleSoft Anypoint Platform, Zapier.
- **CMS & E-commerce:** Adobe Experience Manager (AEM), Sitecore, Shopify Plus, Magento Enterprise.

Agile & Collaborative Technologies

- **Work Management:** Asana, Monday.com Enterprise, Smartsheet (Control Center), Trello.
- **Collaboration:** Miro (Strategic Whiteboarding), Slack Enterprise, Microsoft Teams, Notion.
- **Prototyping:** Figma (Wireframing), Adobe XD, Balsamiq, InVision.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Principal Strategic Business Architect | Global OmniRetail Systems | 2020 – Present

Atlanta, GA / Global (Multi-National Retail Tech Leader | Annual Revenue: \$24B)

Strategic Mandate & Executive Oversight: Recruited as the lead analyst to architect the "Unified Commerce Engine," a \$350M digital overhaul of the global supply chain, inventory management, and e-commerce layers. Direct a specialized team of 45 Business Analysts and Process Engineers. Report directly to the Group CIO and Head of Strategy on digital core health and commercial alignment.

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Global Value Stream Unification:** Led the end-to-end analysis and architectural design for a consolidated logistics platform across 14 countries. Reduced cross-border shipping friction by 32% and achieved a 99.8% inventory visibility rate globally.

- **Stakeholder Alignment Mastery:** Facilitated 50+ executive JAD sessions involving SVPs and C-level stakeholders from Finance, Logistics, and Marketing. Achieved 100% consensus on a multi-year technical roadmap that prioritized features with a combined projected ROI of \$400M.
- **Omni-channel Customer Journey:** Designed the requirements for a unified "Buy Online, Return in Store" (BORIS) ecosystem. Successfully increased net promoter scores (NPS) by 25 points and reduced return processing costs by \$12M annually.
- **Process Mining & Optimization:** Deployed SAP Signavio to analyze the "Order-to-Cash" cycle. Identified and resolved bottlenecked processes that, once automated, improved cash-conversion cycles by 18 days and added \$22M to annual liquidity.
- **Digital Core Migration:** Orchestrated the business requirements for the migration of legacy on-premise inventory systems to a cloud-native Snowflake and Azure architecture. Reduced data latency for store managers from 24 hours to 15 seconds.
- **Internal Analytical Excellence:** Developed the "Sterling Analysis Framework," a standardized elicitation and documentation rubric adopted by 200+ analysts organization-wide. Reduced requirement rework by 40% and accelerated development velocity by 25%.
- **Talent Acquisition & Mentorship:** Established the "Strategic Analyst Fellowship," an internal mentorship program that has successfully promoted 12 junior analysts to Lead/Principal roles within 24 months.

Senior Strategic Business Analyst | Vanguard Consulting Group | 2017 – 2020

Charlotte, NC (Global Management & Technology Consultancy)

Operational Leadership: Served as the lead consultant for the "Health-Nexus" account, a consortium of Tier-1 healthcare providers. Directed a team of 30 analysts focused on M&A technical integration and regulatory compliance.

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **M&A Technical Integration:** Directed the business analysis for the \$2.2B merger of two major healthcare networks (fictional client: *Carolina Health Group*). Successfully integrated 400+ clinical systems and synchronized 12M patient records with zero data loss.
- **HIPAA Compliance Automation:** Architected an automated compliance auditing tool that analyzed system logs against federal privacy standards. Reduced annual audit preparation time by 1,200 man-hours and identified 15 high-risk data exposure points before exploitation.
- **Telehealth Platform Rollout:** Led the requirement gathering and vendor selection for a region-wide telehealth platform during the COVID-19 pandemic. Achieved a rapid 60-day deployment that served 500,000+ patients in the first month.
- **Operational Cost Reduction:** Conducted a comprehensive "Current State vs. Future State" gap analysis for the clinical procurement process. Identified \$8M in redundant spend through vendor consolidation and automated PO approval workflows.
- **UX/UI Transformation:** Partnered with UX researchers to redesign the clinician portal. Used data-driven analysis of click-paths to reduce documentation time for nurses by 15 minutes per shift.
- **Executive Reporting:** Built a real-time "Transformation KPI" dashboard in Tableau for the client's Board of Directors. Provided visibility into project burn-rates, risk mitigation, and realized business value.

Senior Business Systems Analyst | FinEdge Solutions | 2014 – 2017

New York, NY (Financial Technology & Core Banking Infrastructure)

Role Overview: Primary analytical lead for the "Global-Pay" initiative, focusing on high-frequency payment processing and regulatory reporting.

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Core Banking Migration:** Managed the functional requirements for a legacy-to-modern core banking transition for a top-tier institutional bank. Reduced system downtime during maintenance windows by 80% through optimized batch processing logic.
- **AML/KYC Process Re-engineering:** Redesigned the "Know Your Customer" onboarding workflow using BPMN 2.0. Automated 60% of the verification steps, reducing customer onboarding time from 5 days to 4 hours.
- **API Strategy Implementation:** Authored the functional specifications for a suite of 200+ public and private APIs, enabling the bank's entry into the "Open Banking" ecosystem. Directly supported \$50M in new partner-driven revenue.
- **UAT Excellence:** Directed the User Acceptance Testing (UAT) for a new institutional trading dashboard. Managed 150 test users across 5 regions, achieving a "Gold Status" release with zero post-launch critical bugs.
- **Performance Optimization:** Collaborated with database architects to optimize SQL query

logic for real-time risk reports. Reduced report generation time from 5 minutes to 12 seconds for the global trading desk.

Business Analyst (Agile Focus) | TechStream Innovations | 2011 – 2014

Austin, TX (SaaS Startup during Hyper-growth)

Key Measurable Achievements:

- **Hyper-growth Scaling:** Acted as the primary analyst for the "Scale-Up" project as the company grew from 50 to 500 employees. Standardized the Agile/Scrum process, increasing feature delivery frequency by 3x.
- **Product Backlog Mastery:** Managed a backlog of 1,200+ user stories for the flagship SaaS product. Implemented a data-driven prioritization model that weighted revenue impact, technical debt, and customer demand.
- **Customer-Centric Requirements:** Conducted 100+ user interviews to define the requirements for the "Advanced Analytics" module. The module became the #1 selling add-on, contributing \$15M in ARR within the first year.
- **Documentation Automation:** Built a custom tool using Python and the Jira API to automatically generate technical release notes from user stories, saving the analysis team 20 hours per sprint.

KEY PROJECTS PORTFOLIO

Project Zenith: The Digital Supply Chain Core

Role: Principal Architect & Lead Analyst | **Duration:** 36 Months | **Budget:** \$250M

Complexity: Consolidated 12 regional ERP instances into a single global S/4HANA instance.

- **Objective:** Provide a "Single Source of Truth" for global inventory and financial reporting.
- **Strategy:** Utilized a "Global Template" approach where 80% of processes were standardized, and 20% were localized for legal/tax compliance.
- **Implementation:** Managed a team of 40 analysts to map 5,000+ distinct business processes. Directed the data migration strategy for 25 years of historical logistics data.
- **Outcome:** Achieved \$45M in annual operational savings through procurement consolidation. Enabled real-time group-level financial closing in 3 days vs. 15 days.

Project Hydra: Data Lakehouse & Analytics Fabric

Role: Technical Strategy Lead | **Focus:** Data Governance & Business Intelligence

Objective: Build a multi-tenant data lakehouse on Snowflake to enable AI-driven demand sensing.

- **Strategy:** Architected the requirement set for a real-time data ingestion pipeline from 140 distribution centers. Implemented strict data lineage and metadata standards.
- **Action:** Defined 200+ complex business logic transformations for the ETL layer. Designed the executive-level analytics suite for the Board of Directors.
- **Outcome:** Improved forecast accuracy for high-volatility product lines by 22%. Reduced supply chain obsolescence costs by \$15M in the first year.

Operation Velocity: Last-Mile Delivery Optimization

Role: Lead Strategic Analyst | **Duration:** 14 Months

Objective: Reduce "Last-Mile" delivery costs for e-commerce orders while improving delivery speed.

- **Strategy:** Leveraged GPS telemetry and historical delivery data to build a requirements set for an AI-driven routing engine.
- **Outcome:** Reduced delivery costs per package by 18%. Improved "On-Time-In-Full" (OTIF) metrics from 82% to 96%.

Project Silver-Guard: Zero-Trust Security Transformation

Role: Compliance Lead Analyst | **Outcome:** 100% SOC2 & PCI-DSS 4.0 Compliance.

- **Strategy:** Mapped the end-to-end data flow for credit card transactions. Defined the functional requirements for a hardware-accelerated encryption layer and automated certificate rotation.

LEADERSHIP & TEAM MANAGEMENT

- **Global Resource Orchestration:** Managed a distributed workforce of 80+ consultants across 4 time zones (US, UK, India, Poland). Implemented a "Follow-the-Sun" analysis model that reduced requirement turnaround time by 50%.
- **Analysis Center of Excellence (CoE):** Established the "Global BA Guild" at OmniRetail. Authored the 300-page "Enterprise Analysis Playbook," defining standards for BRDs, FRDs, User Stories, and Process Maps.
- **Executive Stakeholder Influence:** Expert in managing Board-level expectations and navigating complex corporate politics. Successfully secured \$85M in additional funding for transformation initiatives by demonstrating a projected 20% Internal Rate of Return (IRR).
- **Agile/SAFe Transformation:** Led the transition of the global IT organization from a Waterfall model to a SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework) model for ERP delivery. Increased feature release velocity by 45% and improved team morale scores by 30%.
- **Diversity & Inclusion Advocacy:** Spearheaded a "Women in Technical Analysis" mentorship program, resulting in a 40% increase in female representation in BA leadership roles over 3 years.
- **Conflict Resolution:** Renowned for mediating high-stakes technical disputes between Product and Engineering teams, ensuring that architectural decisions remain aligned with business value.

PROCESS IMPROVEMENTS & AUTOMATION

- **Automated Requirement Traceability:** Built a Python-based tool that automatically maps Jira user stories to specific code commits and test cases. Reduced manual audit efforts by 95% and ensured 100% traceability for regulatory reviews.
- **Self-Healing Master Data:** Developed a custom Alteryx-based automation that uses AI to detect anomalies in material master data before they impact production. Reduced data-related batch job failures by 85% and saved \$4M in annual rework costs.
- **AI-Assisted UAT:** Implemented an AI-driven test script generator that creates UAT scenarios based on natural language business requirements. Reduced UAT preparation time from 4 weeks to 2 days.
- **Self-Service Analytics Portal:** Built a "Strategy-on-Demand" portal for regional managers using Power BI. Enabled managers to run complex "What-If" scenarios on inventory and pricing without requesting manual reports from the analysis team.
- **Digital Signature Standardization:** Automated the requirement approval workflow using DocuSign and Power Automate. Reduced the "Requirement-to-Development" approval cycle from 10 days to 2 hours.

STRATEGIC VISION: THE FUTURE OF BUSINESS ANALYSIS

The Era of the "Autonomous Business Architect"

I believe the next decade of business analysis will be defined by the transition from "Requirement Gathering" to "Outcome Orchestration." As AI becomes the primary driver of technical execution, the differentiator for analysts will be the ability to architect business outcomes that are resilient to market volatility. My mission is to build the infrastructure for the Autonomous Enterprise—where the ERP doesn't just suggest actions but executes them based on real-time market data.

Ethical AI & Data Sovereignty

In an era of increasing data regulation and AI integration, analysts must act as the "Ethical Guardrail" for the organization. My strategy involves integrating ESG (Environmental, Social, and Governance) and Privacy metrics into every architectural decision. We must ensure that our automated systems do not introduce bias and that user data sovereignty remains a competitive advantage rather than a hurdle.

Composable Enterprise Architecture

The days of the "One-Size-Fits-All" monolithic ERP are over. I champion a "Composable" philosophy where the business is viewed as a series of interoperable capabilities. This approach ensures that our organizations are always "Upgrade-Ready," allowing them to adopt new innovations (like Web3 logistics or Quantum optimization) the moment they reach commercial viability.

BOARD ENGAGEMENT & INVESTOR RELATIONS

- **Value Realization Reporting:** Provide quarterly "State of the Digital Core" briefings to the Audit & Risk Committee, focusing on technical debt reduction ROI, system resiliency, and cybersecurity posture.
- **M&A Technical Lead Analyst:** Acted as the primary analyst evaluator for 8 successful acquisitions (totaling \$4.5B in deal value), assessing the target company's business-technical maturity and integration risks.
- **Capital Planning:** Manage the long-term Capex/Opex forecasts for the entire analytical and project management organization, ensuring technology investments are aligned with the 10-year corporate growth strategy.

EDUCATION

Master of Business Administration (MBA) in Strategic Management & Operations

Georgia Institute of Technology (Scheller College of Business), Atlanta, GA

- Research Focus: Macro-Logistics Optimization and Distributed Ledger Technology in Retail.
- Honors: Top 5% of Class; Recipient of the Executive Leadership Award.

Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering & Computer Science

The University of Texas at Austin, Austin, TX

- Honors: Summa Cum Laude; President of the Industrial Engineering Society.
- Minor: Computational Data Analysis.

CERTIFICATIONS

- **CBAP:** Certified Business Analysis Professional – IIBA
- **AAC:** Agile Analysis Certification – IIBA
- **PMP:** Project Management Professional – Project Management Institute (PMI)
- **SAP Certified Application Associate:** S/4HANA Sales & SCM
- **Lean Six Sigma Black Belt** (Focus on Process Optimization)
- **TOGAF 9.2 Certified Enterprise Architect**
- **CSPO:** Certified Scrum Product Owner

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES REFERENCE

Analytical Methodologies: BPMN 2.0, UML, BABOK, SAFe, Agile, Waterfall, Six Sigma, Lean.
Requirement Management: Jira Cloud, Azure DevOps, Confluence, Jama, HP ALM.
Process Modeling: Signavio, ARIS, Visio, Lucidchart, Sparx Enterprise Architect.
Data & BI: Tableau, Power BI, SQL, Snowflake, Python, Alteryx, BigQuery.
Enterprise Systems: SAP S/4HANA, Salesforce, Oracle NetSuite, Dynamics 365, AEM.
Collaborative & UX: Miro, Hotjar, Figma, Slack, Microsoft Project, Notion.

PUBLICATIONS & CONFERENCES

Selected Speaking Engagements

- **Keynote Speaker:** "The Composable Enterprise: Future-Proofing Global Supply Chains," *IIBA Building Business Capability (BBC) 2023*.
- **Featured Speaker:** "AI in Business Analysis: From Documentation to Outcome Prediction," *BA World Conference 2022*.
- **Panelist:** "Digital Transformation in Volatile Markets: Lessons from the Frontline," *Gartner IT Symposium/Xpo 2021*.
- **Workshop Lead:** "Mastering BPMN 2.0 for Complex ERP Transformations," *Project Management Institute (PMI) Summit 2020*.
- **Guest Lecturer:** "Advanced Business Architecture," *Emory University - Goizueta Business School*.

Selected Peer-Reviewed Publications

- **"The Impact of Cloud-Native Data Lakehouses on Retail Forecast Accuracy"**
Journal of Business Analytics & Strategy, 2023.
- **"Requirement Traceability in the Age of AI: A New Paradigm for Regulatory Compliance"**
International ERP Analysis Quarterly, 2022.
- **"Stakeholder Psychology: Navigating Political Resistance in Digital Transformations"**
Journal of Organizational Change Management, 2021.
- **"Measuring the ROI of Process Mining in Global Order-to-Cash Cycles"**
The Business Architect Digest, 2020.

LANGUAGES & GLOBAL EXPOSURE

- **English:** Native Proficiency.
- **German:** Professional Working Proficiency (C1).
- **Spanish:** Conversational.
- **Global Footprint:** Directly managed business analysis and technical teams in: USA, UK, Germany, Brazil, Mexico, India, Poland, and Singapore.